

Bluefin Sound Fisheries Cooperative

Quota and Harvest Report 2025

Bluefin Sound Fisheries Cooperative - Nova Scotia, Canada

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quay. A board of seven elected skippers meets every second Thursday. The cooperative manages quotas, operates the fuel dock and runs the processing plant on the east Sound, Nova Scotia. Membership grew to 118 member vessels by the end of 2025. The cooperative was founded in 1957 by 22 fishing families and is headquartered in the port of Bluefin

Cooperative Overview

are equipped with electronic logbooks and net sensors.

Nine vessels were replaced in 2025 under the fleet renewal agreement signed in 2023. All new vessels average vessel age is 19 years.

The member fleet consists of 41 longliners, 33 trawlers, 28 gillnetters and 16 coastal handliners. The

Fleet Composition

			96%
	640	612	
Halibut			
			100%
	5,200	5,200	
Herring			
			74%
	1,750	1,301	
Pollock			
			99%
	2,100	2,088	
Haddock			
			95%
	3,600	3,412	
Atlantic cod			
			Utilisation
		Landed (t)	
Species	Quota (t)		

Table 1: 2025 quotas and landings by species

in the second half of the year. No quota was exceeded.

Herring was fully utilised, while pollock remained below quota because the fleet shifted effort to haddock set annually by the regional fisheries authority in consultation with the cooperative.

The table below compares the allocated quotas with the actual landings of the 2025 season. Quotas are

Catch Quotas 2025

monitoring programme in which skippers photograph every haul with a deck camera. Independent observers covered 18 percent of all fishing trips in 2025. The cooperative runs a discard juvenile cod. Mesh size in the trawl fishery was raised to 120 millimetres in 2024. Since 2021 two areas of 40 and 55 square nautical miles are closed to bottom trawling to protect

Sustainability Measures

mostly sold to roe processors in Asia under a fixed annual contract.
The average ex-vessel price for cod was 4.30 USD per kilogram, 6 percent above 2024. Herring is 11,900 tonnes of fish, of which 62 percent was exported to the United States.
The processing plant on the east quay handles up to 90 tonnes per day. In 2025 the plant processed

Processing and Markets

2026.

Heat recovery from the plant refrigeration system will be connected to the fuel dock building in spring. The fleet renewal programme continues with nine further vessels ordered for delivery in 2026 and 2027.

unchanged herring quota. The cooperative has asked for a review of the pollock assessment. For the 2026 season the authority has proposed a 3 percent reduction of the cod quota and an

Outlook 2026